

Word family: home / homes / homeowner / homeownership / homeless / homelessess / hometown / homeland / homecoming / homemade / homegrown / homesick / homesickness / homebody / homeward

Base word: home

Part of speech: noun(名詞) / adverb(副詞) / adjective(形容詞)

Useful family extensions: homeowner, homeless, hometown, homeland, homecoming, homemade, homegrown, homesick, homebody, homeward

Useful compounds: home life, home address, home team, home game, home market, home page/homepage, home screen, home button, home plate, home run

Your sentence:

“...the train was so noisy and crowded that I often **got home** feeling exhausted.”

A full semantic sweep shows that **home** has several genuinely useful meanings, but they revolve around three strong ideas:

1. **the place where someone lives;**
 2. **the place where someone belongs or originates;**
 3. **something connected with one's domestic, local, or home-side context.**
-

Meaning in your passage

Here:

got home

means:

arrived at the place where the speaker lived.

繁體中文：到家；回到自己的住所

Natural translation:

“I often got home feeling exhausted.”

「我經常回到家時已經覺得筋疲力盡。」

Here, **home** functions as an **adverb of destination**:

get home
go home
come home

Notice: there is normally **no “to”**.

1. home = to/at one's residence (副詞) — 回家；到家；在家

This is your original sense.

Practice 1 — Original

“I often **got home** feeling exhausted.”

「我經常回到家時已經筋疲力盡。」

Practice 2

“What time did you get **home**?”

「你幾點到家？」

Practice 3

“She stayed **home** all weekend.”

「她整個週末都待在家裡。」

home — adverb = 朝自己居住的地方移動，或身處自己的住所

Important grammar: go/come/get home, not *to home*

Correct:

- go home
- come home
- get home
- arrive home

Normally not:

- *go to home* ❌
- *get to home* ❌

But with a possessive/noun phrase:

“I went **to his home**.”

「我去了他的住所。」

Because here **home** is a noun.

2. home = physical residence (住宅／住所) — 家；住所；住宅

Here, **home** is a noun.

Practice 4

“They bought a new **home** near the station.”

「他們在車站附近買了一個新家／住宅。」

Practice 5

“Her **home** was damaged in the storm.”

「她的住所在暴風雨中受損。」

home = 一個人平日居住、生活的房屋／住所

This can be:

- a house;
- an apartment;
- another type of residence.

So **home** does not mean only “house.”

3. **home = family/domestic life** (家庭生活) — 家庭; 家庭生活

Home can mean not just the building, but the domestic/family environment.

Practice 6

“He had a happy **home**.”

「他有一個幸福的家庭／家庭生活環境。」

Practice 7

“She tries to balance work and **home**.”

「她努力在工作和家庭生活之間取得平衡。」

home = 與家庭成員、家庭關係和日常居家生活有關的生活環境

4. **home = place of belonging/comfort** (歸屬感) — 家; 有歸屬感的地方

This is an important figurative meaning.

Practice 8

“This city finally feels like **home**.”

「這座城市終於讓我有家的感覺／歸屬感。」

Practice 9

“For her, the theatre became a second **home**.”

「對她來說，劇院成為了她的第二個家／很有歸屬感的地方。」

home = 令人感到安全、熟悉、自在並有強烈歸屬感的地方

A place does not have to be your legal residence to **feel like home**.

5. **home** = place of origin/native place (原鄉／出生地／故鄉) — 家鄉；故鄉；原居地

Practice 10

“Hong Kong will always be **home** to her.”

「香港永遠都是她的家鄉／心中的故鄉。」

Practice 11

“After ten years abroad, he returned **home**.”

「在海外生活十年後，他回到了家鄉／故鄉。」

home = 一個人認為自己來自、成長或具有深厚身份連結的地方

This may be:

- birthplace;
 - hometown;
 - country;
 - region.
-

6. home = natural/usual place of an animal, plant, culture, industry, company (自然／主要所在地) — 棲息地；發源地；大本營；所在地

The subject does not need to be a person.

Practice 12

“The rainforest is **home to** thousands of species.”

「這片雨林是數千種生物的棲息地。」

Practice 13

“The city is **home to** many technology companies.”

「這座城市是許多科技公司的所在地／集中地。」

be home to = 是某些生物、人物、機構、文化或產業主要存在／聚集的地方

Natural Chinese varies:

- animal → 棲息地
- company → 所在地
- culture/art form → 發源地／重要基地

7. home = residential institution (住宿照護機構) — 院舍；之家；住宿機構

This is a genuinely important institutional meaning.

Practice 14

“She works in a nursing **home**.”

「她在一家護理院／安老院工作。」

Practice 15

“The child was placed in a children’s **home**.”

「那名兒童被安排入住兒童院舍。」

home — institution = 為某類人士提供長期住宿、照顧或支援的機構

Common:

- nursing home = 護理院／安老院
 - care home = 護理院舍
 - children’s home = 兒童之家／兒童院舍
-

8. home + noun (家庭／居家) — 家用的；家庭的；在家進行的

Here, **home** functions attributively.

Practice 16

“The company sells **home appliances**.”

「公司銷售家用電器。」

Practice 17

“She has a small **home office**.”

「她在家裡有一個小型家庭辦公室／在家工作的辦公空間。」

home + noun = 與家庭、住所或居家使用有關的

Common:

- home address = 住址
 - home life = 家庭生活
 - home cooking = 家常菜
 - home entertainment = 家庭娛樂
 - home office = 家庭辦公室
-

9. home team / home game / home crowd (體育) — 主隊; 主場; 主場觀眾

Home contrasts with away.

Practice 18

“The **home team** won 3–1.”

「主隊以 3 比 1 勝出。」

Practice 19

“They have three **home games** this month.”

「他們今個月有三場主場比賽。」

home — sport = 在自己球場／場館作賽的一方或與主場有關的

Common:

- home team = 主隊
 - home game = 主場比賽
 - home crowd = 主場觀眾
 - home advantage = 主場優勢
-

10. home market/company/country (本國／本地) — 國內的; 本土的; 本國市場的

A common business/economic use.

Practice 20

“The company is strong in its **home market**.”

「這家公司在自己的本土市場／國內市場很有實力。」

Practice 21

“Demand is falling in the company’s **home country**.”

「這家公司在其本國的需求正在下降。」

home — business/geography = 與某家公司、品牌或個人本國／本土市場有關的

Contrast:

home market = 本土市場

overseas/foreign market = 海外／外國市場

11. home = homepage/home screen/home button (科技) — 首頁；主畫面；主頁功能

A major modern technology extension.

Practice 22

“Tap **Home** to return to the main screen.”

「按下「主畫面／首頁」返回主要畫面。」

Practice 23

“The news appears on the app’s **home screen**.”

「新聞會顯示在應用程式的主畫面。」

home — technology = 系統、網站或應用程式中作為主要起點／返回起點的頁面或介面

Common:

- homepage / home page = 首頁
- home screen = 主畫面
- home button = 主畫面鍵

The metaphor is:

home = the place you return to

12. home = home plate (棒球) — 本壘

A genuinely distinct sports meaning.

Practice 24

“The runner reached **home** safely.”

「跑壘員安全回到本壘。」

Practice 25

“He slid into **home**.”

「他滑壘進入本壘。」

home — baseball = 跑壘員必須返回以完成得分的本壘位置

Common related compound:

home plate = 本壘

13. home run (棒球／比喻) — 全壘打；大成功

A useful family-extension compound.

Practice 26

“He hit a **home run**.”

「他擊出一支全壘打。」

Practice 27

“The new product was a **home run** for the company.”

「這款新產品對公司而言是一次大成功。」

home run — figurative = 非常成功、效果極佳的事情

Especially common in American English.

14. at home = in one's residence — 在家

Practice 28

"I'll be **at home** tonight."

「我今晚會在家。」

Practice 29

"She works **at home** twice a week."

「她每星期有兩天在家工作。」

at home = 身處自己的住所

15. feel/be at home = feel comfortable/familiar — 感到自在; 有歸屬感

A very useful figurative expression.

Practice 30

"I immediately felt **at home** in the new office."

「我在新辦公室裡很快就感到自在、像自己熟悉的地方一樣。」

Practice 31

"She is completely **at home** with technology."

「她對科技非常熟悉自在、應付自如。」

be/feel at home = 對某個地方、環境或領域感到熟悉、自在而沒有陌生感

The second example extends beyond physical home:

at home with something
= 對某事非常熟悉／自在

16. make yourself at home — 不用拘束；當自己家一樣

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 32

“Come in and **make yourself at home**.”

「進來吧，別拘束，就當自己家一樣。」

Practice 33

“Please make yourself at home while I make some tea.”

「我去泡茶，你不用客氣，隨意一點。」

make yourself at home = 放鬆、自在，不必像客人般拘謹

17. a home away from home / home from home — 像家一樣舒服的地方

Practice 34

“The small hotel became a **home away from home**.”

「那間小酒店成為一個像家一樣舒服自在的地方。」

Practice 35

“The café feels like a **home from home**.”

「那間咖啡店有一種第二個家的感覺。」

home away from home / home from home = 雖不是自己的真正住所，但讓人有熟悉、安全和舒適感的地方

- **home away from home** especially common in American English
 - **home from home** especially common in British English
-

18. homeowner = person who owns their home — 自置物業人士；業主

Practice 36

“Many **homeowners** are worried about repair costs.”

「很多自置物業人士／住宅業主都擔心維修費用。」

Practice 37

“The programme provides support for first-time **homeowners**.”

「這項計劃為首次置業人士提供支援。」

homeowner = 擁有自己所居住房屋／住宅物業的人

19. homeownership = owning one's home — 自置居所；置業

Practice 38

“High prices have made **homeownership** more difficult.”

「高樓價令置業／自置居所變得更加困難。」

Practice 39

“The study examines rates of **homeownership**.”

「研究分析自置住宅比例。」

homeownership = 擁有自己住宅的狀態／制度／比例

20. **homeless** = without a stable home — 無家可歸的；沒有固定住所的

Practice 40

“The charity supports **homeless** people.”

「這間慈善機構支援無家可歸人士。」

Practice 41

“The fire left several families **homeless**.”

「火災令幾個家庭失去住所、無家可歸。」

homeless = 沒有穩定、安全、固定住所可居住的

21. **homelessness** = condition of lacking stable housing — 無家可歸；無固定居所狀況

Practice 42

“The city introduced measures to reduce **homelessness**.”

「城市推出措施減少無家可歸問題。」

Practice 43

“Housing costs can contribute to **homelessness**.”

「住屋成本可能導致無固定住所的情況。」

homelessness = 個人／群體缺乏安全、穩定住所的社會和生活狀況

22. hometown = town/city someone comes from — 家鄉；故鄉城市

Practice 44

“She returned to her **hometown** after university.”

「她大學畢業後回到自己的家鄉。」

Practice 45

“My **hometown** has changed a lot.”

「我的家鄉改變了很多。」

hometown = 一個人成長、出生或認為自己來自的城鎮／城市

23. homeland = country/territory considered one's native land — 祖國；故土；家園

Practice 46

“They eventually returned to their **homeland**.”

「他們最終回到了自己的故土／祖國。」

Practice 47

“The song expresses love for the **homeland**.”

「這首歌表達了對故土／祖國的熱愛。」

homeland = 一個人／民族具有深厚身份、歷史或文化連結的本土／祖國

24. **homecoming** = return home after being away — 歸來；返鄉

Practice 48

“Her **homecoming** was an emotional occasion.”

「她的歸來／返鄉令人非常感動。」

Practice 49

“The team received a warm **homecoming**.”

「球隊回來時受到熱烈的歡迎／歸隊歡迎。」

homecoming = 離開一段時間後返回家鄉、住所或原來所屬地方

In American education, **Homecoming** can also be a specific school/university tradition.

25. **homemade** = made at home rather than commercially — 自家製的；家中製作的

Practice 50

“She brought some **homemade** cake.”

「她帶來了一些自家製蛋糕。」

Practice 51

“The restaurant serves **homemade** soup.”

「餐廳供應自家製湯品。」

homemade = 在家／店內自行製作，而不是工廠大量生產的

Often implies:

- personal;
 - traditional;
 - less industrial.
-

26. homegrown = grown locally/at home — 自家種植的；本地種植的

Practice 52

“They sell **homegrown** vegetables.”

「他們出售自家種植／本地種植的蔬菜。」

Practice 53

“The restaurant uses **homegrown** herbs.”

「餐廳使用自家種植的香草。」

homegrown — literal = 在自己家中、土地上或本地種植的

27. homegrown = locally developed/native (人才／技術／文化) — 本土培養的；本地發展的

A useful figurative extension.

Practice 54

“The company invests in **homegrown talent**.”

「公司投資培養本土人才。」

Practice 55

“The country developed a **homegrown** technology industry.”

「這個國家發展出自己的本土科技產業。」

homegrown — figurative = 在本地培養、發展或產生，而不是從外地引進的

28. homesick = unhappy because away from home — 思鄉的；想家的

Practice 56

“She felt **homesick** during her first month abroad.”

「她在海外第一個月感到很想家／思鄉。」

Practice 57

“I became **homesick** after a few weeks.”

「幾個星期後，我開始想家。」

homesick = 因離開熟悉的家、家人或家鄉而感到難過和想回去的

29. homesickness = sadness from being away from home — 思鄉；想家

Practice 58

“He struggled with **homesickness**.”

「他受到思鄉情緒／想家的感覺困擾。」

Practice 59

“Homesickness is common among students living abroad.”

「在海外生活的學生出現思鄉情緒很常見。」

homesickness = 因長時間離開家／家鄉而產生的思念和難過情緒

30. **homebody** = person who prefers staying at home — 愛待在家的人；宅在家的人

A very useful modern family extension.

Practice 60

“I’m a bit of a **homebody**.”

「我算是一個很喜歡待在家的人。」

Practice 61

“He’s a **homebody** who rarely goes out at night.”

「他很宅／喜歡待在家，晚上很少外出。」

homebody = 比起外出社交，更喜歡留在家中活動的人

Informal but very common.

31. **homeward** = toward home — 朝家的方向；回家的

Slightly more literary/formal, but useful.

Practice 62

“They began their **homeward** journey.”

「他們開始了回程／回家的旅程。」

Practice 63

“The commuters were heading **homeward**.”

「通勤人士正朝家的方向回去。」

homeward = 朝向住所／家鄉的方向

Also:

homewards in British English.

Important distinction: home vs house

This is essential.

house

= physical building

“They bought a large house.”

「他們買了一棟大房子。」

home

= place where someone lives, often including emotional/domestic meaning

“They made the house feel like home.”

「他們把那棟房子營造成真正有家的感覺。」

So:

house = 建築物

home = 居住＋家庭／歸屬概念

A house can exist without being anyone's home.

Important distinction: home vs hometown

home

can be your current residence or place of belonging.

hometown

specifically refers to the town/city you come from.

“Seattle is my home now, but Vancouver is my hometown.”

「西雅圖現在是我的家，但溫哥華是我的家鄉。」

Important distinction: home vs homeland

home

personal residence/belonging.

homeland

larger national/ethnic/cultural territory.

home = 家

hometown = 家鄉城市

homeland = 故土／祖國

Important distinction: home vs residence

home

normal everyday word and can carry emotional belonging.

residence

formal and mainly refers to the place where someone officially lives.

“home address”

normal

“place of residence”

formal/legal

Important distinction: at home vs home

Direction:

“I’m going **home**.”

No **at**.

Location:

“I’m **at home**.”

So:

- go home = 回家
 - be at home = 在家
-

Important distinction: home vs domestic

home

everyday modifier:

home cooking
home address

domestic

more formal and can mean:

- household-related;

- internal to one country.

domestic violence
domestic market
domestic flight

The overlap is strongest in business:

home market
domestic market

Both can mean 本土市場.

Important distinction: home market vs local market

home market

= the company's own domestic national market.

local market

= market in a particular local geographical area.

A multinational's **home market** may be an entire country, not merely a nearby local area.

Important distinction: home team vs local team

home team

= team playing at its own venue in that particular match.

local team

= team from the local area.

A local team can still be the **away team** in a particular game.

Important distinction: homepage vs home screen

homepage

main starting page of a website.

home screen

main screen/interface of a phone, tablet, app, etc.

Both use the metaphor:

home = main starting/return point

Important distinction: homemade vs homegrown

homemade

= made/prepared at home or by the seller rather than industrially.

homemade bread

homegrown

= grown locally/at home; figuratively developed locally.

homegrown vegetables

homegrown talent

Do not interchange them.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- **home — adverb** = 回家／到家／在家
- **home — residence** = 家／住所
- **home — family life** = 家庭／家庭生活
- **home — belonging** = 有歸屬感的地方
- **home — place of origin** = 家鄉／故鄉
- **home to + species/company/culture** = 棲息地／所在地／發源地
- **home — institution** = 院舍／之家

- **home + noun — household** = 家用／家庭的
- **home team/game** = 主隊／主場
- **home market/country** = 本土／國內
- **home — technology** = 首頁／主畫面
- **home — baseball** = 本壘
- **home run** = 全壘打；比喻大成功
- **at home** = 在家；自在熟悉
- **make yourself at home** = 不用拘束
- **home away from home / home from home** = 像家一樣舒服的地方
- **homeowner** = 自置物業人士
- **homeownership** = 自置居所／置業
- **homeless** = 無家可歸的
- **homelessness** = 無家可歸狀況
- **hometown** = 家鄉
- **homeland** = 故土／祖國
- **homecoming** = 返鄉／歸來
- **homemade** = 自家製
- **homegrown — literal** = 自家／本地種植
- **homegrown — figurative** = 本土培養／發展
- **homesick** = 想家的／思鄉的
- **homesickness** = 思鄉情緒
- **homebody** = 愛待在家的人
- **homeward/homewards** = 朝家的方向

I would not flood this family with every transparent **home-** compound such as *homework*, *homebuyer*, *homebuilding*, etc. unless a later lesson needs them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
home — adverb	朝自己居住的地方移動，或身處自己的住所
home — residence	一個人平日居住和生活的房屋／住所
home — family life	與家庭成員、家庭關係和居家日常有關的生活環境
home — belonging	令人感到熟悉、安全、自在並具有歸屬感的地方
home — origin	一個人來自、成長或具有深厚身份連結的地方／家鄉
be home to	某些生物、人物、機構或文化主要存在／聚集的地方

home — institution	為特定人士提供長期住宿和照顧的院舍／機構
home + noun	與家庭、住所或居家使用有關的
home — sport	在自己場館作賽的一方／主場相關的
home — business/geography	與公司或個人的本國／本土市場相關的
home — technology	系統、網站或裝置中作為主要起點／返回點的頁面或介面
home — baseball	跑壘員返回並完成得分的本壘位置
home run	棒球全壘打；比喻非常成功的事情
at home — literal	身處自己的住所
at home — figurative	對某地方、環境或領域感到熟悉自在
homeowner	擁有自己住宅物業的人
homeless	沒有安全、穩定、固定住所可居住的
hometown	一個人成長、出生或認為自己來自的城鎮／城市
homeland	一個人／民族具有深厚身份和文化連結的故土／祖國
homecoming	離開一段時間後返回家鄉／原所屬地方
homemade	在家或店內自行製作，而不是工廠大量生產的
homegrown — literal	在自己家中、土地上或本地種植的
homegrown — figurative	在本地培養、發展或產生，而不是外地引進的
homesick	因離開家、家人或家鄉而感到難過、想回家的
homebody	比起外出社交，更喜歡留在家中活動的人
homeward	朝住所／家鄉方向移動的

For your original sentence

“...I often **got home** feeling exhausted.”

The exact meaning is:

home = 說話者自己居住的住所，並以副詞方式表示「到達家中」

So:

got home

= 「到家／回到家」

And the crucial grammar rule is:

go home / come home / get home ✓

go to home / get to home ✗

That remains one of the most useful learner points in the whole **home** family.